A COMPANION TO

HANDWRITING WORTH SIGNING

52 Weeks

of Lines Worth Writing

Every week

Emma R. Thistlewood

INSIDE

A year of practice

The year at a glance, with a box to tick for each week 2

Weeks 1 to 52, one page each 3

HOW TO USE IT

- Day 1: read the line, trace the grey copy from the dots, then write it twice.
- Day 2: write the one word in the brush hand, trace first, then on your own.
- Day 3: answer the question in your own words: real writing, not copying.
- About 15 minutes a session, at a comfortable speed (Chapter 7).

Start any week of the year. Date the page when you begin, and every few months compare Week 1 with your latest page.

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The year at a glance

Tick a box when you finish a week. Every line here was first published long ago and is free for anyone to copy.

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WEEK 1

Started _____

Well begun is half done.

Proverb

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Well begun is half done.

Well begun is half done.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Begun Begun

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What is one small thing you could start today and finish this week?

WEEK 2

Started _____

To thine own self be true.

William Shakespeare, Hamlet

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

To thine own self be true.

To thine own self be true.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

True True

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write about a time you stayed true to yourself when it was not easy.

WEEK 3

Started _____

Be not afraid of greatness.

William Shakespeare, Twelfth Night

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Be not afraid of greatness.

Be not afraid of greatness.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Greatness Greatness

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What would you try if you knew you could not fail?

WEEK 4

Started _____

Little strokes fell great oaks.

Benjamin Franklin, Poor Richard's Almanack

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Little strokes fell great oaks.

Little strokes fell great oaks.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Oaks Oaks

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Which small daily habit has added up to something big for you?

WEEK 5

Started _____

Hitch your wagon to a star.

Ralph Waldo Emerson, Society and Solitude

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Hitch your wagon to a star.

Hitch your wagon to a star.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Star Star

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Name one goal that feels a little too big. Why does it pull at you?

Started _____

Hope is the thing with feathers that perches in the soul.

Emily Dickinson

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Hope is the thing with feathers that perches in the soul.

Hope is the thing with feathers that perches in the soul.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Hope Hope

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What are you hoping for this season?

WEEK 7

Started _____

We are such stuff as dreams are made on.

William Shakespeare, The Tempest

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

We are such stuff as dreams are made on.

We are such stuff as dreams are made on.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Dreams Dreams

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Describe a dream you remember, sleeping or waking.

WEEK 8

Started _____

I celebrate myself, and sing myself.

Walt Whitman, Song of Myself

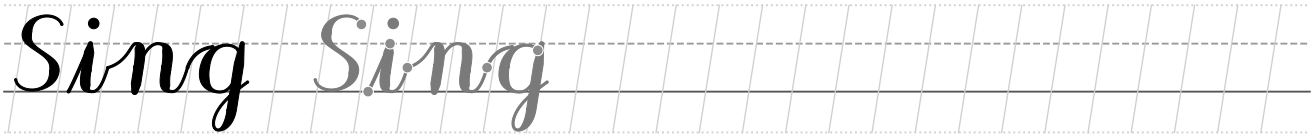
MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

I celebrate myself, and sing myself.

I celebrate myself, and sing myself.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

List three things you like about yourself, and why.

WEEK 9

Started _____

Our life is frittered away by detail. Simplify, simplify.

Henry David Thoreau, Walden

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Our life is frittered away by detail. Simplify, simplify.

Our life is frittered away by detail. Simplify, simplify.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Simplify Simplify

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What could you let go of to make next week simpler?

Started _____

Earth laughs in flowers.

Ralph Waldo Emerson, Hamatreya

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Earth laughs in flowers.

Earth laughs in flowers.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

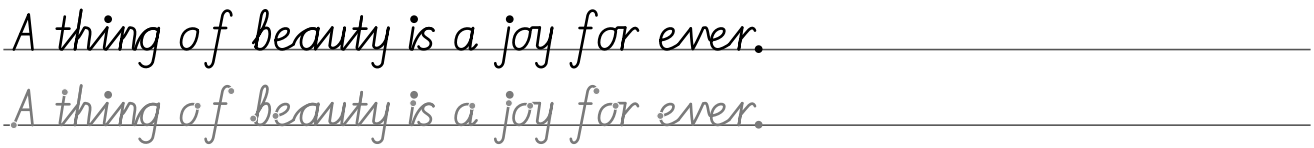
Which flower, tree or garden do you love, and where did you first see it?

Started _____

A thing of beauty is a joy for ever.

John Keats, Endymion

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS



WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What beautiful thing did you notice this week?

WEEK 12

Started _____

Into each life some rain must fall.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow, The Rainy Day

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Into each life some rain must fall.

Into each life some rain must fall.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Rain Rain

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write about a hard day that taught you something.

Started _____

Hope springs eternal in the human breast.

Alexander Pope, An Essay on Man

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Hope springs eternal in the human breast.

Hope springs eternal in the human breast.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Spring Spring

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

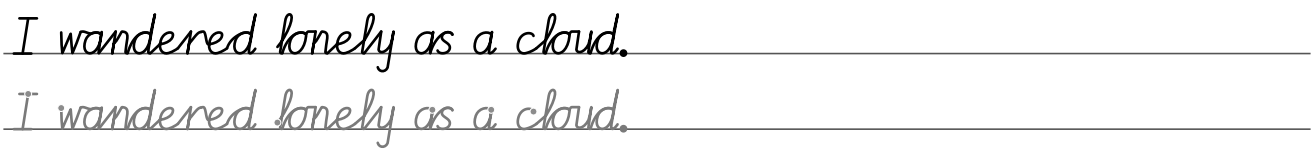
What is starting again in your life right now?

Started _____

I wandered lonely as a cloud.

William Wordsworth

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS



WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Where do you go when you want to be alone with your thoughts?

Started _____

To see a world in a grain of sand.

William Blake, Auguries of Innocence

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

To see a world in a grain of sand.

To see a world in a grain of sand.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Describe one tiny object near you in as much detail as you can.

Started _____

The child is father of the man.

William Wordsworth, My Heart Leaps Up

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The child is father of the man.

The child is father of the man.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What did you love as a child that you still love today?

WEEK 17

Started _____

Afoot and light-hearted I take to the open road.

Walt Whitman, Song of the Open Road

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Afoot and light-hearted I take to the open road.

Afoot and light-hearted I take to the open road.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Road Road

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Where would you go on a trip with no plan?

Started _____

To err is human, to forgive divine.

Alexander Pope, An Essay on Criticism

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

To err is human, to forgive divine.

To err is human, to forgive divine.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Forgive Forgive

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Is there someone you are ready to forgive, yourself included?

Started _____

Well done is better than well said.

Benjamin Franklin, Poor Richard's Almanack

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Well done is better than well said.

Well done is better than well said.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Done Done

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What have you been talking about doing? Write the first step.

WEEK 20

Started _____

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want.

Psalm 23, King James Bible

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want.

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Shepherd Shepherd

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Who has looked after you, and how could you thank them?

Started _____

To every thing there is a season.

Ecclesiastes 3, King James Bible

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

To every thing there is a season.

To every thing there is a season.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Season Season

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Which season of the year suits you best, and why?

Started _____

Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?

William Shakespeare, Sonnet 18

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?

Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Summer Summer

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write the best summer day you can remember.

Started _____

I went to the woods because I wished to live deliberately.

Henry David Thoreau, Walden

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

I went to the woods because I wished to live deliberately.

I went to the woods because I wished to live deliberately.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Woods Woods

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What would living on purpose look like for you this week?

Started _____

Heaven is under our feet as well as over our heads.

Henry David Thoreau, Walden

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Heaven is under our feet as well as over our heads.

Heaven is under our feet as well as over our heads.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Heaven Heaven

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Name a place close to home that feels special to you.

Started _____

Nothing great was ever achieved without enthusiasm.

Ralph Waldo Emerson, Circles

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Nothing great was ever achieved without enthusiasm.

Nothing great was ever achieved without enthusiasm.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Enthusiasm Enthusiasm

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What gets you excited enough to lose track of time?

Started _____

What's in a name? That which we call a rose by any other name would smell as sweet.

William Shakespeare, Romeo and Juliet

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

What's in a name? That which we call a rose
by any other name would smell as sweet.
What's in a name? That which we call a rose
by any other name would smell as sweet.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Rose Rose

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

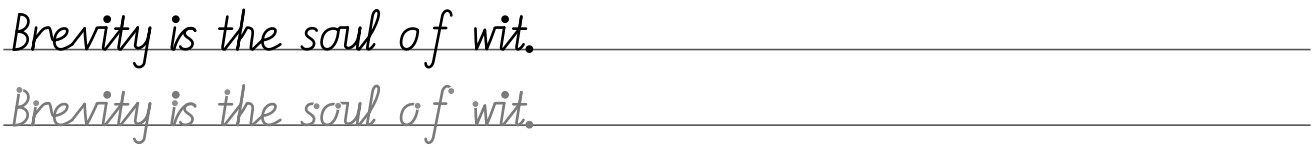
Where does your name come from? Write its story.

Started _____

Brevity is the soul of wit.

William Shakespeare, Hamlet

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS



WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write a thank-you note to someone in ten words or fewer.

WEEK 28

Started _____

I'm nobody! Who are you?

Emily Dickinson

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

I'm nobody! Who are you?

I'm nobody! Who are you?

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Nobody Nobody

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Describe a quiet person you admire.

Started _____

The world is so full of a number of things, I'm sure we should all be as happy as kings.

Robert Louis Stevenson, Happy Thought

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The world is so full of a number of things,
I'm sure we should all be as happy as kings.
The world is so full of a number of things,
I'm sure we should all be as happy as kings.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Happy Happy

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

List ten small things that made you happy this month.

Started _____

My love is like a red, red rose.

Robert Burns

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

My love is like a red, red rose.

My love is like a red, red rose.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Red Red

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write a few lines to someone you love. You do not have to send them.

Started _____

Who has seen the wind? Neither I nor you.

Christina Rossetti, Sing-Song

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Who has seen the wind? Neither I nor you.

Who has seen the wind? Neither I nor you.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Wind Wind

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What changes have you felt but not seen?

Started _____

Grow old along with me! The best is yet to be.

Robert Browning, Rabbi Ben Ezra

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Grow old along with me! The best is yet to be.

Grow old along with me! The best is yet to be.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Best Best

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What are you looking forward to in ten years?

Started _____

How do I love thee? Let me count the ways.

Elizabeth Barrett Browning, Sonnets from the Portuguese

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

How do I love thee? Let me count the ways.

How do I love thee? Let me count the ways.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Count the ways you love a person, a place or a thing.

WEEK 34

Started _____

To strive, to seek, to find, and not to yield.

Alfred, Lord Tennyson, Ulysses

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

To strive, to seek, to find, and not to yield.

To strive, to seek, to find, and not to yield.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Strive Strive

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What are you working toward right now?

Started _____

'Tis better to have loved and lost than never to have loved at all.

Alfred, Lord Tennyson, In Memoriam

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

'Tis better to have loved and lost
than never to have loved at all.
'Tis better to have loved and lost
than never to have loved at all.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write about someone you miss.

Started _____

Though she be but little, she is fierce.

William Shakespeare, A Midsummer Night's Dream

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Though she be but little, she is fierce.

Though she be but little, she is fierce.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Fierce Fierce

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Who is the bravest small person you know?

Started _____

The course of true love never did run smooth.

William Shakespeare, A Midsummer Night's Dream

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The course of true love never did run smooth.

The course of true love never did run smooth.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Love Love

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

How did two people you know meet?

Started _____

There is no charm equal to tenderness of heart.

Jane Austen, Emma

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

There is no charm equal to tenderness of heart.

There is no charm equal to tenderness of heart.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write about the kindest thing anyone has done for you.

WEEK 39

Started _____

I declare after all there is no enjoyment like reading!

Jane Austen, Pride and Prejudice

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

I declare after all there is no enjoyment like reading!

I declare after all there is no enjoyment like reading!

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Reading Reading

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Which book would you give to a friend, and why?

WEEK 40

Started _____

With malice toward none, with charity for all.

Abraham Lincoln, Second Inaugural Address

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

With malice toward none, with charity for all.

With malice toward none, with charity for all.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

How could you help someone in your neighborhood?

Started _____

Charity suffereth long, and is kind.

1 Corinthians 13, King James Bible

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Charity suffereth long, and is kind.

Charity suffereth long, and is kind.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Kind Kind

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Write about a small kindness you saw this week.

Started _____

This is the day which the Lord hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.

Psalm 118, King James Bible

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

This is the day which the Lord hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.

This is the day which the Lord hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Rejoice Rejoice

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What made today a good day?

Started _____

Write it on your heart that every day is the best day in the year.

Ralph Waldo Emerson, Society and Solitude

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Write it on your heart that every
day is the best day in the year.
Write it on your heart that every
day is the best day in the year.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Heart Heart

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Plan the best ordinary day you can imagine.

Started _____

Let us, then, be up and doing.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow, A Psalm of Life

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Let us, then, be up and doing.

Let us, then, be up and doing.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What will you do this week that you have put off?

Started _____

Beauty is truth, truth beauty.

John Keats, Ode on a Grecian Urn

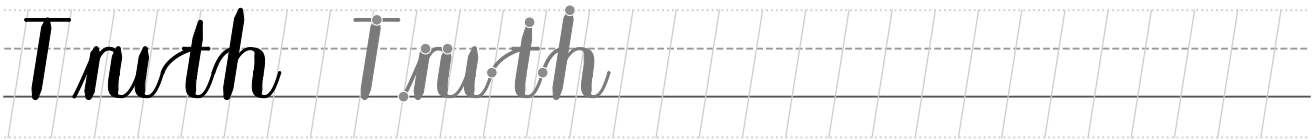
MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Beauty is truth, truth beauty.

Beauty is truth, truth beauty.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

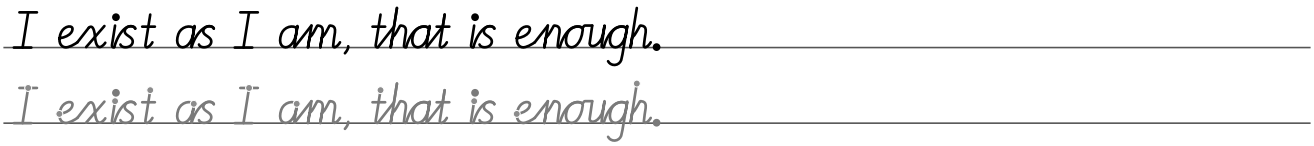
What is something you know is true, even if others doubt it?

Started _____

I exist as I am, that is enough.

Walt Whitman, Song of Myself

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS



WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What do you already have that is enough?

Started _____

The sun is but a morning star.

Henry David Thoreau, Walden

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The sun is but a morning star.

The sun is but a morning star.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Sun Sun

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Describe a sunrise or a morning you remember.

WEEK 48

Started _____

Where there's a will, there's a way.

Proverb

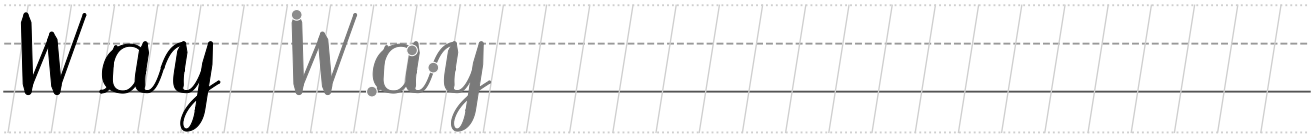
MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Where there's a will, there's a way.

Where there's a will, there's a way.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What problem are you close to solving?

Started _____

All the world's a stage.

William Shakespeare, As You Like It

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

All the world's a stage.

All the world's a stage.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Which role do you play most often: host, helper, listener, leader?

Started _____

The quality of mercy is not strained.

William Shakespeare, The Merchant of Venice

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

The quality of mercy is not strained.

The quality of mercy is not strained.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Mercy Mercy

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

When did someone give you a second chance?

Started _____

Early to bed and early to rise makes a man healthy, wealthy, and wise.

Benjamin Franklin, Poor Richard's Almanack

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

Early to bed and early to rise makes
a man healthy, wealthy, and wise.
Early to bed and early to rise makes
a man healthy, wealthy, and wise.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND

Early Early

THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

What does your ideal morning look like?

WEEK 52

Started _____

All's well that ends well.

William Shakespeare

MODEL, THEN TRACE FROM THE DOTS

All's well that ends well.

All's well that ends well.

WRITE IT TWICE

ONE WORD IN THE BRUSH HAND



THIS WEEK, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Look back over these weeks: which page are you proudest of?